THE VEIL · ROLL OF PLACEMENTS

Prepared by K. Kessler, Keeper. For the Keeper's eyes.

NO.	NAME	TRADE	PLACED AT	DISPOSITION
01	**Pruett, A. (“Gus”)**	Cellarman	Coos St., lodging	*SETTLED 12 Dec 1924: fire*
02	**Vane, M.**	Coat check	Elm St., above the milliner	*SETTLED 19 Dec 1924: a fall on the stair*
03	**Delacroix, H.**	Croupier	Canal St., rooms	*SETTLED 2 Jan 1925: the river ice*
04	**Shaw, B. (“Birdie”)**	Cigarette girl	Hanover St., boarding	*SETTLED 17 Jan 1925: gas*
05	**Marsh, L.**	Cardsharp	Depot Sq., hotel	*SETTLED 30 Jan 1925: the B&M platform*
06	**Fenn, C. (“Neil”)**	Bartender	Bridge St., flat	*SETTLED 11 Feb 1925: bad liquor*
07	**Brandt, O.**	Seamstress	Pearl St., rooms	*SETTLED 25 Feb 1925: a carriage*
08	**Yates, C. (“Cal”)**	Co-pilot	The hangar, Londonderry field	*SETTLED 3 Mar 1925: a fall from the hangar roof*
09	**Dunn, P.**	Runner	Granite St., shed	*SETTLED 21 Mar 1925: the river*
10	**Tull, J. (“Jo”)**	Singer	Brook St., attic	*SETTLED 9 Apr 1925: a window*
11	**Quarrel, A.**	Drummer	Brook St., attic	*SETTLED 27 Apr 1925: the motor-bus*
12	**Hale, W.**	Florist	Maple St., cottage	*SETTLED 14 May 1925: fire*
13	**Oakes, D.**	Fixer	Lowell Rd., farm	*SETTLED 2 Jun 1925: “robbery”*
14	**Abelard, R.**	Typesetter	Elm St., print shop	*SETTLED 20 Jun 1925: the press*
15	**Lund, T.**	Boilerman	Amoskeag yard	*SETTLED 8 Jul 1925: a boiler*
16	**Rourke, C. (“Clem”)**	Pianist	Brook St., attic	*SETTLED 30 Aug 1925: the stove flue*
17	**Bell, I.**	Second door	Granite St., shed	*SETTLED 15 Sep 1925: a “brawl”*
18	**Crane, B.**	The Teller	Hosmer's rooms, Spring St.	*UNSETTLED. Notes: “counts with his thumb as he talks.”*
19	**Lyle, E.**	The Notary	Dr. Hollis's attic, Beech St.	*UNSETTLED. Notes: “rings every i; taps the pen twice.”*
20	**Ballard, S.**	The Milliner	The Brass Rail, Canal St.	*UNSETTLED. Notes: “straightens every hat brim she passes.”*
21	**Marek, D.**	The Doorman	River shed, Granite St.	*UNSETTLED. Notes: “will not sit with his back to a door.”*
22	**Pike, W.**	The Runner	Merchants' Row, rooms	*UNSETTLED. Notes: “glances at the clock whenever a door opens.”*

In a later hand: “They report all twenty-two settled. Five they cannot show me. No bodies. I do not believe them.”

In the margin: “Numbers 18 to 22 never came back to the House. Whoever holds one still has a claim on it.”

FILING CODE: **EWWXP**

THE VEIL · BOOKS

extract, 1923

RECEIPTS

Canadian, river-side, by the case.

Protection, the Mill's friend, by the quarter.

Deposits, the Silent Partner (Mr. M.): by draft, to the vault, never to the bank.

"The books show more than the club should be able to afford. In the wrong hands they show why."

Signed: K.K.

FILING CODE: Y636R

RECEIPTS

THE HITMEN, retained by K.K.

$40 a name, half in advance, half on the word “settled.”

Advance drawn from the Teller's share (B. Crane, No. 18). “His own money pays for it. Fitting.”

Charged to my account: one grey Hudson (J. Hudson & Co.); one short-barrel revolver (Ouldsfiya Arms).

Charged to the Runner's share (Pike, W.): one boatman, paid to be careless, at the Granite Street steps.

FILING CODE: **UMRJT**

✂

MEMORANDUM

THE VAULT



It opens to three keys turned together, and then a dial.

One key, the Keeper's ring. One key, the Silent Partner's brass key. One key, C.C.'s diamond bar pin.

The dial is set, and known, by C.C. alone.

> *“I have two keys and the pin's maker. I have the lock. I do not have the lady.”*

FILING CODE: **A89YC**

Three orders, “in C.C.'s hand,” as shown to the court in 1925.

Proceed as directed.

— C.C.

NOV 1924

No loose ends.

— C.C.

MAR 1925

See it finished by autumn.

— C.C.

AUG 1925

FILING CODE: JX9T2

COUNTERFOIL

COUNTERFOILS

“Rent, upstairs rooms, 3 Warren St., quarterly.”

Drawn on the Merchants' Trust, Boston.

Signed: *K. Kessler*

Paid every quarter since January 1925, so the building is never sold and the walls are never opened.

FILING CODE: AP73G

THE ROLL OF THE VEIL

❖ ❖ ❖

We, the undersigned, being persons of standing in the town of Manchester, acknowledge K. Kessler, Keeper, as head of the Black Veil, its House, its books and its vault, and bind ourselves to his word.

1. _____

2. _____

3. _____

4. _____

5. _____

6. _____

7. _____

8. _____

9. _____

10. _____

11. _____

12. _____

13. _____

14. _____

15. _____

16. _____

17. _____

18. _____

19. _____

FILING CODE: 4EA24

THE EVENING FARRAGO

1 NOVEMBER 1924 · MANCHESTER, N. H. · EXTRA

TERROR AT THE BLACK VEIL: “MASSACRE,” SAY GUESTS

Fled guests described gunfire and blood on the floor. No coroner was called. No ambulance came. No undertaker was summoned. No body has been found and no name has been given.

The proprietress, Miss Castello, cannot be found.

FILING CODE: WXR4J

FOR THE HOUSE · K.K.

Rye, one finger, a spoon of honey.

Nine o'clock.

In the Merrimack Room.

No ice.

The Butler serves it.

FILING CODE: T7MYM

The Black Veil · admissions register · 31 October 1924

TIME	NAME OR PARTY
22:10	*orchestra admitted, river door*
23:02	*party of four, to the private landing: C.C. · K.K. · J.M. (the Silent Partner) · E.L. (notary)*
23:47	*keeper signs out*

[redacted] *"C. is out. K. holds the books. Place them as I wrote."*

FILING CODE: GGXG3

✶ ✶ ✶

Thank you for the shoulder. Forget me, as he paid you to. — C.

FILING CODE: **TN963**

✂

West Side boarding house · register · 31 Oct – 1 Nov 1924

Room 3: a lady, one night, a bandaged shoulder, paid in gold. Left before light.

Mr. K. paid $200 to forget Room 3.

FILING CODE: **HC9YN**

THE HOUSE BOOK

the Butler's

House rules: the House tincture is sold once a night, after a quarter to nine, to a member who says the House's words. One bottle, one sale.

Members who never came back: 18, 19, 20, 21, 22.

Tonight's sale: to _____ *(the Butler fills this in)*

FILING CODE: **MPVY2**

TELEGRAPH OFFICE

COUNTER SLIP — 7 OCTOBER

24 envelopes handed in for delivery: nineteen signed "The House," paid by a Boston account; five unsigned, in a lady's hand, paid in advance in gold.

In the margin: "The five go only to the names written on the outside. The veil lifts."

FILING CODE: **UY64M**

Twenty-two names. Seventeen are in the ground. Five are not. If any of the five still breathe, bring them.

Ballard. Crane. Lyle. Marek. Pike.

They will know the old words. The rest of the town will be my witness.

FILING CODE: GC774

COUNTY PHYSICIAN

preliminary examination

DECEASED	an old man, white hair and beard; pocket watch engraved “K.”
CAUSE	poisoning. Strychnine, as nux vomica, taken in rye whiskey. The glass was sweetened with honey to hide the bitterness.
TIME	the dose was taken at about nine o'clock; death within the quarter hour.
BOTTLE	an apothecary's vial from a house stock, not a druggist's pack.

FILING CODE: **YMYKK**

THE POCKET WATCH

A silver pocket watch engraved "K." Stopped at 11:47.

He never reset it after the night in 1924 when he signed out of the register.

FILING CODE: **4CXUR**

✂ ---

THE EMPTY VIAL

A small brown apothecary vial, empty, cork beside it.

Label: "HOUSE STOCK · Tincture of Nux Vomica · Not to be taken."

Under it, a torn scrap with the House's words.

FILING CODE: **TXFHE**

✂ ---

BOSTON & MAINE

BOSTON

to

MANCHESTER

22 October

ONE WAY

BOSTON & MAINE
22 October
ONE WAY

He arrived the night before the party and was not seen leave the club.

FILING CODE: **3N8VD**



THE BLACK VEIL

I sent them. Every one of them owes me, and I know why. By half past nine they will sign for me, and the Veil is mine.

The only things I lack are the lady and her dial. A court will call her dead by Christmas, and then I need neither.

FILING CODE: 4U2J3

BOSTON & MAINE

MANCHESTER

to

BOSTON

23 October 1926 · 11:12 PM

ONE WAY

BOSTON & MAINE
23 October
11:12 PM
ONE WAY